



PRELIMINARY EVALUATION

Pitch briefing

What each part of the pitch means, and the questions to be ready for — for the team.



Engineer It with AI 2026 · internal — for the team

Problem + Solution · 1 min

Value + Business model · 1 min

Future + Team · 1 min

Live demo · 2 min

01 Problem

Graduate unemployment in the Gulf is not a shortage of degrees — it's that a graduate can't tell which real jobs they qualify for, or what stands between them and the role they want, until the effort is already spent. Our own survey of graduates and final-year students here in Oman makes this concrete: **roughly two-thirds** have read a job posting and couldn't tell whether a course they took actually counts as the skill being asked for; **nearly nine in ten** are blocked by postings demanding experience they don't have; and **nearly half** of those who were rejected couldn't even say why. So they apply blindly — some to more than a hundred jobs — and the words they chose for how they feel were exhausted, frustrated, and anxious. The problem is a missing map between what a graduate already has and what the market actually rewards.

02 Solution

Itqan is a career navigator that starts from where the graduate wants to go, not from a job listing. They name a target role — or Itqan suggests roles they're already close to — and it reads their transcript and CV to measure exactly which skills they have, which they're missing, and **how far** they are from that role, judged against live Gulf market demand rather than a generic checklist. From there it lays out the shortest upskilling path to close that gap, and matches the graduate to the jobs that fit them best right now, each with a plain reason for the match. Reading the transcript is only the starting measurement; the product is the market-aware gap, the path, and the fit.

This is what graduates asked us for. The single strongest thing that would earn their trust was "explain why I qualify", and several are already doing a rough version of this by hand in ChatGPT — which tells us the demand is real, and that a purpose-built tool will beat a manual prompt.

03 Unique value & competitors

Every tool graduates use today does only half the job. Job boards like Bayt and LinkedIn match people to jobs by the keywords they already typed; course platforms like Coursera sell them courses. None of them tells a graduate how far they are from the role they actually want, exactly what to do to get there, and then finds their best-fit job — and none does it in Arabic. That gap is the whole product. It isn't a guess: our survey shows almost everyone uses LinkedIn, yet many also turn to an AI assistant specifically to work out their skill gaps, because nothing does it for them. Itqan owns the market-calibrated gap-to-target and best-fit path; it maps skills to real demand by meaning, not by single keywords (one graduate told us she'd distrust a tool that saw "introduction to accounting" on her HR transcript and pushed her toward accounting); and its recommendations are never for sale. The point is not to be a better job board — like Airbnb beside hotels, it's a different category.

04 Business model

The graduate never pays to get hired — that is the trust moat, and it's deliberate. The core is free forever: the gap analysis, the full upskilling path, the top job matches, and the Hud advisor. A paid tier adds the full job list, heavier Hud use, and multi-document scanning, aimed at people who actually have income — career-switchers and power users — not the unemployed graduate. The real long-term engine is different again: employers and universities pay for access to consented, pre-qualified national candidates, riding Gulf nationalisation quotas that make placing nationals a funded legal obligation rather than a favour. Itqan never sells a ranking — recommendations can't be bought — which is both what sets it apart and an honesty guarantee.

Our survey draws this free/paid line for us: **about half** of graduates have paid for job-search help before, so willingness to pay exists — but several told us they wanted to and couldn't afford it. That is exactly why the core stays free and the paid tier is aimed at those who can.

05 Future plans

The core product is built and live; right now the focus is hardening how well it reads messy, phone-scanned transcripts. After the competition the path runs in three stages. **First**, a beachhead in Oman: institutional and employer pilots, riding the national push for 300,000 opportunities and partnering with Khuta as a distribution channel rather than competing with a government platform. **Next**, expansion to where the pain and the money are largest — Saudi Arabia, then the wider Gulf — using the Oman pilots as proof, and widening beyond IT into other fields. **Finally**, the product itself grows into a career-long companion: salary benchmarking, readiness for the next promotion, and re-skilling as the market shifts. That last stage is where the usual "we succeed, so the user leaves" problem is solved, because the value now outlives the first job.

06 Team & skills

This section has to show the panel two things: that we have the right people, and that we're unusually well placed to win. The four of us hold complementary roles with a clear sense of who owns what — **name · role** **name · role** **name · role** **name · role** . Beyond the mix of skills, our position is rare: we're embedded at UTAS, which is both our first pilot customer and the exact population our survey drew from; and our regulator, MTCIT, is also this competition's sponsor and the ministry that runs Khuta — so a compliant, useful Itqan is pushing on a door that's already open. We build PDPL-first: the graduate uploads their own transcript and consents in the app, which our survey shows they'll do once the tool explains itself and lets them verify what it found.

07 Live demo

The demo is the most important part of the pitch — it's live, it's weighted heavily, and the rules are explicit that it must be the real working product, not a video or a mockup. The run should walk one real scenario from start to finish: upload a real transcript, let the graduate confirm the extracted courses (nothing is inferred until they confirm — a trust moment worth naming out loud), pick a target role and reveal the gap and how far they are against live demand, show the shortest path to close it, and finish with the best-fit matches and a question answered by Hud. Have a Plan B ready — a pre-loaded profile to fall back on instantly if a live call stalls — and rehearse the exact click-path many times, because a frozen screen loses the room faster than anything we could say.

ALSO CARRY THIS

AI safety & oversight is 15% of the score, and we cover it without a separate slide. Weave these four points into the demo, the business model, and the Q&A: a human confirms the extracted courses before anything is inferred; Itqan only recommends real, retrieved jobs and courses — it never invents them; recommendations are never for sale, so results can't be commercially biased; and it's PDPL-first, with in-app consent and in-region hosting.

QUESTIONS TO BE READY FOR

How many graduates did you actually survey?

Be honest — don't dodge. This wave focused on Omani graduates and final-year students, mostly in IT — deliberately, because that's our UTAS beachhead. These are early signals from exactly the users we're launching to, and we're widening the sample next. The patterns were strong and consistent even in this focused group.

Your paying user is broke and cancels the moment you succeed. How is that a business?

It isn't — which is why the graduate is never our primary payer. The paid tier targets career-switchers who have income; the real revenue is employers and universities, who are obligated by nationalisation quotas to place nationals. When a graduate gets hired, the employer got a hire and the university's placement number moved — so our success becomes our payer's success.

Aren't you just another job board, or an HR tool?

No. Job boards match on what you already typed; we start from the role you want, measure how far you are, and give you the path there — then the best-fit job. And we're deliberately not a recruiter tool: the graduate is always the user; employers only get access to a consented candidate flow, never a dashboard, and never a paid ranking.

How is agentic AI actually central here, not just a feature bolted on?

The work is a chain of reasoning a rule-based system can't do: read a messy bilingual transcript, infer real competencies, weigh them against live market demand, and assemble a path and a match with a reason for each. Four agents reason and act across those steps — that's the product, not a wrapper.

How accurate is it on real, messy, scanned transcripts?

That's the hardest problem, and we treat it as the product, not a detail. A human-confirmation step turns a scanning error into a corrected input, and we ground every match in real postings so nothing is invented. We're measuring accuracy on real transcripts now — trust is the thing we're hardening.

What stops LinkedIn or Coursera from just adding this?

Distribution, yes — but not the regional stack. Reading an Arabic transcript and mapping it to live Gulf demand needs an Arabic reading and data layer global players have deprioritised. Owning that quality before they bother is our moat.

What's your unfair advantage — why you?

We're embedded at UTAS, which is our first pilot and our survey population; our regulator, MTCIT, is also the competition sponsor and runs Khuta; and we're building the Arabic transcript-to-Gulf-demand quality no one else has. That's an open institutional door plus a hard-to-copy data asset.

What about funding — how do you survive?

We're deliberately pre-revenue right now. The asset we're building is proof on real transcripts and pilot access. We'll raise later, from evidence and leverage, not need. (Don't claim an investor we don't have.)

Is this PDPL-compliant, given MTCIT is the regulator?

Yes, by design. The graduate uploads their own transcript and consents in the app, which avoids any university-to-vendor transfer, and we host in-region. For us compliance is a credibility asset, not a hurdle.